

9v9 Team Rotation & Substitution Guide for Coaches

This guide outlines the structured substitution system used to ensure fair playing time, consistent positional development, and smooth match flow for our 9v9 teams.

Objectives

- Provide approximately equal playing time for all players
- Maintain consistent positional development
- Minimise disruption during matches
- Make substitutions simple and predictable for coaches

Team Structure

During matches the team will play with:

- 3 Attackers
- 2 Midfielders
- 4 Defenders (including the goalkeeper)

Players remain in their assigned positional group for the entire game and rotate only with players from the same group.

Position Group	Players in Squad	On Field	Bench
Attackers	4	3	1
Midfielders	3	2	1
Defenders	5	4 (incl GK)	1

Substitution Timing

Substitutions occur every **8 minutes**. At each rotation coaches substitute:

- 1 attacker
- 1 midfielder
- 1 defender

Match blocks:

0–8 min | 8–16 min | 16–24 min | Halftime | 25–33 min | 33–41 min | 41–49 min

Goalkeeper Rotation

Two players rotate as goalkeeper:

- Goalkeeper 1 plays the entire first half
- Goalkeeper 2 plays the entire second half

Goalkeepers are not substituted during their goalkeeper half. In the other half they rotate normally within the defender group.

Substitution Tracker

Coaches will receive a pre-filled substitution timeline showing the entire game across a horizontal timeline. Each column represents an 8■minute block and each row represents a player. At each substitution time coaches simply follow the next column and swap the indicated players.

Benefits of This System

- Fair playing time across the squad
- Consistent positional development
- Clear and predictable substitutions
- Minimal disruption to game flow
- Allows coaches to focus on coaching rather than tracking minutes